HTML, XHTML, and XML: A Comparison
Rewritten response

HTML provides the elements used to structure content for browsers.
Its parsing rules are designed to make webpages widely accessible.
XHTML keeps HTML vocabulary but follows stricter XML well-formedness.
For example, elements must close and nesting must be correct.
XML is a general data format that lets authors define meaningful tags.
It carries information between systems rather than styling a page.
Thus, HTML focuses on rendering, XHTML on strict web documents,
and XML on representing and exchanging structured data.

The best choice depends on whether the goal is display or data.